

JON BAKER

Baker's -9 Rewrites TEG History

No one at Boavista's clubhouse had seen a net score like it, and the record books hadn't either.

On Tuesday 5 October 2010, at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort in Lagos, Algarve, Jon Baker played the best round in TEG history. A net -9 in the first round of the 2010 TEG Trophy. His gross of 19 over par also stands as the third-best gross round recorded in TEG history to date.

There was no explosive run to point at. The round was built on sustained accuracy, which is a quieter way of dismantling a field. Between the 7th and the 9th he gained three shots to par. That stretch included a bogey

on the par-5 8th, one of the hardest holes on the course, and he still came out three to the good. Later, across the 13th and the 14th, he went two holes without dropping a single gross shot. Back-to-back pars to close it out. In this company, that is thunder.

The round was also a personal course best for Baker at Boavista. His gross 90 improved on the 100 he had carded there previously, a swing of 17 strokes from his last visit to the course.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY

Jon BAKER (-9)

TROPHY LEAD

Jon BAKER, 8 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD

David MULLIN, 2 ahead

ROUND NET VP

JB -9 | DM -1 | SN +4 | GW +5 | HM +8

ROUND GROSS

DM +17 | JB +19 | SN +22 | HM +28 | GW +35

AFTER R1 • TROPHY

JB -9 | DM -1 | SN +4 | GW +5 | HM +8

AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET

DM +17 | JB +19 | SN +22 | HM +28 | GW +35

SIDEBAR

Mullin's Record 88 Grabs the Jacket

Two competitions changed hands within a single round, and a third was already beyond saving for Henry Meller.

Round one at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort, on the group's fourth visit to the course, produced a new course record. David Mullin carded a gross 88, beating the previous mark of 89 and improving on his own prior best at the course. His +17 gross stands as the best gross round in TEG history to date. His net -1 ranks as the third-best round in TEG history to date. The record book was

rewritten twice in one afternoon, and nobody asked its permission.

It put Mullin in front for the 2010 TEG Green Jacket after the first round. Jon Baker took the lead in the 2010 TEG Trophy, level with the field on net score.

At the other end, Henry Meller unravelled. Bogeys from the 9th through the 13th, then a double

bogey at the 14th. A birdie at the 16th suggested a man recovering his composure. It was a misdirection. At the par-4 17th, one of the easiest holes on the course, he took 12. It was the worst hole of his round and the worst hole of the tournament relative to par. The 17th asked very little of him. He gave it everything. It dropped him to the bottom of the 2010 TEG Wooden Spoon race.

GREGG WILLIAMS

Thirteen Shots in Four Holes

The card that started as his best round in four years ended as barely believable.

Gregg Williams's opening round at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort was already under strain by the turn. Between the 8th and the 10th he dropped seven shots in three holes. A double bogey on the par-5 8th. Another double on the 9th, the easiest hole on the course. A triple on the 10th. A quadruple-

bogey 7 followed at the short 6th, which he will not wish to revisit.

But the round did not truly unravel until the finish. From the 15th, the hardest hole on the course, through to the 18th, Williams produced four bogeys of escalating severity: triple, triple, triple and a closing quadruple. Thirteen shots

gone in four holes. Not one net par among them. Escalating is the precise word. He was building to something.

The middle of the round had promised a great deal. The finish buried it. He ended short of his own best score on the course, with nothing to show for the earlier work.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 3, Round 1

TEG RECORDS

- Jon Baker's -9 is the best round in TEG history to date
- Jon Baker's +19 (gross) is the 3rd-best Gross round in TEG history to date
- David Mullin's +17 (gross) is the best Gross round in TEG history to date
- David Mullin's -1 is the 3rd-best round in TEG history to date

RARE FEATS

- Henry Meller runs up a 12 (+8) at the 17th — a new TEG-record and career-worst on a par-4